AMERICAN PLACES

1.3 Central Park New York City

On July 21, 1853, the New York State Legislature set aside more than 750 acres of land in the middle of Manhattan Island to establish America's first major landscaped park. Sensibly called "the Central Park," it was designed by architects and social reformers who believed that great parks would benefit public health and contribute to a "civil society." Central Park sparked the urban park movement, one of the most significant developments in 19th-century America. After several decades of disrepair and neglect, the park was restored during the late 1900s and early 2000s, and it has never been more beautiful, safe, and clean. It proudly represents the American ideals of great public spaces, health and wellness, and the preservation of nature within an urban setting. Which different physical features do you observe in the photo of Central Park?



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CRITICAL VIEWING New Yorkers and visitors alike seek out Central Park, a natural refuge in "the city that never sleeps." The park's ponds, meadows, grassy hills, and rocky paths are a welcome break from the loud streets and towering buildings of the city. What does this photograph reveal about the types of activities people can do in Central Park?

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